

Businesses that wish to guard against spyware, adware and other unwanted applications will benefit from supplementing traditional protection methods (including firewalls, intrusion detection systems and antivirus programs) with new strategies that address the unique characteristics of spyware. A comprehensive, company-wide spyware-prevention strategy should include multiple elements:

1. Detailed Acceptable Use Policies (AUP) For Company-owned Computers:

An effective company-wide policy should specifically address the ways in which spyware may enter, including browsing to non-work-related sites, opening unsolicited e-mail attachments, and installing unauthorised and/or non-work-related applications. If such activities are allowed, the AUP should establish configuration and usage procedures that would help to protect the company against inadvertent pest installation. While AUPs are an effective employee education method, they are not sufficient on their own to protect against intentional or accidental violations. It's not sufficient to allow individual users to employ their own favourite anti-spyware products. Spyware can migrate from one PC to another attached to internal e-mails and other communications. The best approach is to use a networked anti-spyware solution that provides for a level of centralised management that ensure all your PCs and servers are covered and alerts the IT manager of spyware incursions.

2. Threat-specific Protection

Unauthorised third parties will always find new ways to access forbidden data or resources. As noted previously, anti-virus programs do not provide reliable protection against spyware; therefore, dedicated tools are required.

Businesses considering the deployment of company-wide protection against spyware, adware and other malicious applications will benefit from solutions that: